



A Guide Book of Regulations for Ph.D. Programme

(Effective from August 2026)

Indian Institute of Information Technology Kottayam (IIIT Kottayam or Institute) is established in 2015 with a major objective to set up an education model which can produce best-in-class human resources in IT and which can harness the multidimensional facets of IT in various domains. To develop new knowledge in information technology and to provide manpower of global standards for the information technology industry. IIIT Kottayam is committed to

emerging amongst the foremost institutions in information technology and allied fields in the global context, to advancing new knowledge and innovation that empowers the nation, and to developing competent and capable youth imbued with the spirit of innovation and entrepreneurship with a social and environmental orientation. The Institute pursues these objectives through applied research and education in selected domain areas, with the aim of contributing significantly to India's global competitiveness across the key sectors of its economy and industry.

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Ordinances

1. The Indian Institute of Information Technology Kottayam (IIIT Kottayam) awards the degree of Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) in Engineering/ Sciences/ Humanities/ Management to a candidate who has successfully completed the stipulated Programme of Research.
2. The Programme of Research with the governing rules and regulations are formulated by the Senate of the IIIT Kottayam (Institute). The Senate can modify or change the structure, the governing rules and regulations from time to time.
3. A candidate to be awarded the Ph.D. degree has to submit a thesis embodying the findings of his/her research carried out under this programme. The thesis should make an original contribution of high quality to the advancement of knowledge as judged by the experts in the relevant area.
4. A candidate becomes eligible for the award of the Ph.D. degree after fulfilling all the academic requirements prescribed by the Senate of the Institute.
5. The award shall be made upon the recommendation of the Senate of the Institute after ratification by the Board of Governors of the Institute.
6. The Ph.D. degree shall be awarded in the discipline of the Department which registers the scholars for the Ph.D. programme.

Regulations

R1. Admission

The Institute admits Ph.D. scholars or scholars under different status: full-time, regular, and external registrants under the following categories, if they are eligible:

1. **Scholarship Holders**

A candidate in this category works full-time in the Institute for his/her Ph.D. degree. He/she receives assistantship/fellowship from INSPIRE/CSIR/UGC/NBHM/QIP or any other recognized funding agency but no financial assistance/scholarship from the Institute.

Such candidates are required to perform the teaching assistantship and other duties assigned by the department from time to time.

2. Sponsored

A candidate in this category is sponsored from a recognized R&D organization, academic institution, government organization or industry for doing research in the Institute on a full-time basis. The candidate must be a regular employee of the sponsoring organization with at least one year of professional experience in the respective field. The Institute does not provide any financial assistantship/fellowship/scholarship to such scholars.

An intending sponsored candidate must submit his/her application in prescribed form along with 'no objection cum sponsorship certificate' for admission through his/her employer, to the Institute with suitable endorsement.

A sponsored candidate selected for admission shall be required, at the time of joining the Institute, to produce certificate in the prescribed form from the employers to the effect: (i) that he/she has been officially released from his/her duties for purpose of joining the programme and has been granted leave for the required period; (ii) that his services may/shall be retained with the employer. All the regulations of full time scholars are applicable to this category.

3. Self-financing

A candidate in this category works full-time in the Institute towards the Ph.D. Programme. The Institute will not provide any financial assistantship/fellowship/scholarship to such scholars. All the regulations of full time scholars are applicable to this category.

4. External Registrants

A candidate working in Industries/Research Organisations/Academic Institutions (including entrepreneurs/ self-employed) can register as External Registrant and do research work either in their own organisation along with their regular work or in the host institute. A no objection certificate issued by the competent authority of parent organization or an appropriate proof for the engagement shall be attached with the application for admission. The IIIT Kottayam does not provide any financial assistantship/fellowship/scholarship to such scholars.

Such candidates will pursue the Ph.D. programme along with their regular job at parent Industry/Research Organisations/Academic Institutions. There is no mandatory residential requirement (R 4.2) for the candidates from the Industries/Research Organisations including entrepreneurs/self-employed.. They are required to complete the for-

malities such as Coursework (prescribed courses can be offline/online), but the Semester registration, DC meetings, Comprehensive examination, Synopsis open seminar, Synopsis submission and Thesis submission shall be offline at the campus, including end semester examinations of registered courses offered by the Institute, as per the relevant sections of this regulations. In addition to these, there shall be offline meetings with the guide, if instructed by the guide. Residential requirement to complete the course work prescribed by the DC is mandatory for the scholars from the academic institutions.

5. Ph.D. through sponsored Project

A candidate working in a sponsored project in the Institute can register to the Ph.D. programme under project category. The minimum remaining period of the project should be at least 2 years from the date of joining the Ph.D. programme. They will do research work along with their regular project work. They shall submit recommendation of the Principal Investigator and HoD along with the application.

If such a scholar resigns from the project job or is terminated upon completion of the contract/project period and leaves the Institute, the scholar shall be allowed to continue the research work, provided the Doctoral Committee (DC) recommends the same, based on the application for conversion.

The Institute does not provide any financial assistantship/fellowship/scholarship to such scholars for his/her Ph.D. programme. All the regulations of full time scholars are applicable to this category.

6. Apart the above categories, scholars are also admitted under integrated scheme through B.Tech. and M.Tech. programmes.

R2. Eligibility for admission

(i) For admission to the Ph.D. Programme in Engineering/Sciences, a candidate must satisfy the following criteria:

- Two year Master's degree in Computer Science and Engineering/Information Technology/Mathematics/ Statistics/Computer Science/Computer Applications/Electronics and Communication Engineering/Electrical and Electronics Engineering or equivalent area from a recognized/approved Institute, with a minimum Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) of either 6.5 in a 10 point scale or 60 % of marks.

(ii) For admission to the Ph.D. Programme in Digital Humanities, a candidate must satisfy the following criteria:

- Two year Master's degree in Humanities, Sciences, Arts, Linguistics, Media, Communication, Engineering or related disciplines from a recognized/approved Institute/University, with a minimum Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) of either 6.5 in a 10 point scale or 60% of marks. Candidates with graduation in Engineering and interest in interdisciplinary research may be preferred.

(iii) For admission to the Ph.D. Programme in Management, a candidate must satisfy the following criteria:

- Two year Master's degree in Management including MBA, MHRM, MSW-HR or an equivalent PG degree or 2 years PG Diploma in management from a recognized/approved Institute/University, with a minimum Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) of either 6.0 in a 10 point scale or 55% of marks. Candidates with graduation in Engineering and interest in interdisciplinary research may be preferred.

Integrated Programmes:

(iv) **Admission to MS-Ph.D.:**

- Four-year Bachelor's degree in Computer Science and Engineering/Information Technology/Electronics and Communication Engineering/Electronics and Electrical Engineering/Mathematics or equivalent in a relevant area from an Institute of National Importance (under GOI) with a minimum CGPA of either 8.0 in a 10 point scale or 75% of marks are eligible to apply to the integrated scheme MS-Ph.D.

Such scholars, if admitted, will be awarded both MS and Ph.D. degrees on completion of Ph.D. programme without any exit option during the programme.

(v) **Direct Ph.D. from B.Tech.-MS (IIIT Kottayam).**

- A student of IIIT Kottayam who is continuing his/her B.Tech.-MS programme and having a minimum CGPA of 8.0 at the end of sixth semester at first attempt and without failures, are eligible to apply for Ph.D. programme of the institute in the beginning of his/her seventh semester of study. Such scholars can receive B.Tech.-MS and Ph.D Degrees only on completion of Ph.D. programme.

(vi) **Direct Ph.D. from M.Tech. for working professionals (IIIT Kottayam):**

- A student from M.Tech. for working professionals, offered by the Institute, who have a minimum CGPA of 8.0 up to 5th semester at first attempt and without failures, are eligible to apply for Ph.D. programme in the beginning of their 6th semester.

(vii) **Direct Ph.D. from e-M.Tech. (IIIT Kottayam):**

- A student from e- M.Tech. offered by the Institute, who have a minimum CGPA of 8.0 up to 3rd semester at first attempt and without failures, are eligible to apply for Ph.D. programme in the beginning of their 4th semester.

R3. Admission Procedure

Twice every year, scholars are admitted to the Ph.D. Programme, at the beginning of the Odd (August) and Even (January) semesters of the Institute. Applications will be invited through press advertisement and announcement at the Institute website: www.iiitkottayam.ac.in. The eligible candidates will be called for a written test and/or interview at IIIT Kottayam. The names of the selected candidates will be announced via the institute website.

R4. Enrolment & residential requirement

1. The selected candidate has to register for the Ph.D. Programme by producing all original certificates of qualifications starting from 10th class, certificates of sponsorship/No objection certificate (if any) and payment receipt of prescribed fees, on the specified day of registration.

The fee structure shall be decided by the Institute, from time to time and will be made available to the candidates.

2. A minimum of one semester (preferably first semester) residential requirement is to be completed by all the Ph.D. registrants (not mandatory for external registrants (R1.4) from the industries and research organizations) during the completion of course credit requirements (R11). However, for candidates from academic institutions, residential requirement is mandatory.

R5. Duration of the Programme

The minimum and maximum duration of the Ph.D. Programme are 6 semesters and 10 semesters respectively for all categories from the date of first registration for Ph.D. programme

to the date of submission of Ph.D. thesis.

Period of sanctioned/permitted semester breaks/ maternity leave of the scholars (R.8) will not be counted for the above maximum duration.

Under extraordinary circumstances, based on the recommendations of the Doctoral committee (DC) on valid reasons from the scholar, an extension period of maximum two semesters (one year) may be considered by the Senate. In such cases, scholar shall have substantial progress in the research at the end of the 10th semester, with minimum one SCI journal and one Scopus conference publications. Extension will be given initially for one semester and may be extended, if required, after the review of the progress.

Nevertheless, at the end of 12 semesters (6 years) from the date of their first registration, no further extension will be normally given, leading to the cancellation of his/her registration.

R6. Registration

1. All research scholars are required to register in each semester during the stipulated period or date notified by the institute till submission of the thesis.
2. The registration for continuation of Ph.D. programme in any semester is subject to approval of the DC (as per R.10) based on the progress of his/her previous semester.
3. Registration involves payment of the prescribed fees for the semester and courses, if any.
4. Late registration upto a specified date may be permitted by Dean (Academics), with payment of late fee notified.
5. After 10 semesters, continuation of the course registration must have approval of the senate (as per R.5).
6. If registration/enrollment is not done for a period of six months (one semester) without any response from the candidate, the registration will be canceled administratively. Re-registration requests for such cases shall be considered as per R16.3.
7. A scholar may be exempted from payment of the tuition fee for the last semester if he/she has completed all the formalities of thesis submission including synopsis except the thesis and will submit the thesis within 30 days from beginning of the semester.

R7. Fellowship/Assistantship

Financial assistantships from external funding organizations will be available as per the terms and conditions of the concerned funding organizations. It is mandatory that all the scholars receiving financial assistantships from the Institute or fellowships/scholarships from any other funding agencies are required to perform academic/teaching assistantship duties as per Institute norms. The continuation of the financial assistantship/fellowship/scholarship is subject to satisfactory performance of the assigned academic/ teaching assistantship duties and satisfactory progress of the scholar in the Ph.D. Programme. Financial Assistance/ scholarships cannot be availed from two funding sources at a time. Academic/Teaching Assistant duties are assigned by the respective department. Such duties include assistance in teaching laboratories, tutorial sessions in courses, grading assignments, library duties, computational labs, conduct of examinations or any other academic duties assigned by the Head of the concerned Department.

R8. Leave Rules

Application for leave of absence should be submitted in the format available from the academic office along with necessary supporting documents e.g. medical certificate, if applicable. Leave should not usually be availed without prior permission of the HoD.

- i. A full-time Ph.D. scholar is eligible for 30 days leave for every completed year (calculated in terms of two consecutive semesters, from the time of his/her joining the programme). Saturdays, Sundays or holidays during the leave period are counted towards leave, except for prefixed or suffixed holidays.

Of the 30 days leave, a maximum of 15 days of leave is permitted in a semester. However, a maximum of 5 days of such leave is only allowed to avail at a stretch, if the scholar is having any teaching assignment/assistantships duties or any other duty assigned by the guide/HoD.

The maximum number of carried-over leave, from one completed year to another, is 15 days.

- ii. A scholar is eligible for maternity/paternity leave as per applicable rule of Govt of India, only once during the Ph.D. Programme.
- iii. In addition to above, a scholar may be permitted to take academic leave on the following grounds based on the recommendation of Guide/Doctoral Committee and Head of the

Department and approved by Dean(Academics):

- a. A maximum of 15 days of leave is permissible in a calendar year to attend conferences/ seminars/workshops/trainings/short-term courses relevant to his/her research area.
- b. A maximum of 30 days of leave in a calendar year is permissible for field trips required for data collection, survey work, field test/measurements required for research. Financial assistance/scholarship if any from the Institute may not be sanctioned during this period.
- c. Academic leave of more than 30 days but up to a maximum of two semesters is also permissible to carry out part of the research in a collaborative way in another premier higher learning institute/R&D Lab/industry in India or abroad, if found essential by the DC. For sanction of such a leave, a letter of consent from the host institute/organisation is required. This leave is permissible only after the scholar has passed the comprehensive examination and has done a good part of the research work at IIIT Kottayam. On recommendations of the guide, the doctoral committee (DC), HoD and Dean Academics, the Chairman, Senate will approve such academic leaves, which shall be reported to the senate. Degree will be awarded to the scholar by IIIT Kottayam only, once the research work is completed and satisfied the norms as per R17.

Financial assistance/scholarship if any from the Institute cannot be availed during this period. During such period of leave, scholar shall pay prescribed fees in every semester and register followed by DC meeting/recommendation. If a registration date falls during the period of academic leave, scholar can complete the registration procedures at the expiry of the academic leave.

- iv. a. A scholar can avail semester breaks up to a maximum of two semesters during the entire duration of the programme, on prolonged illness or other very valid and essential reasons etc. based on recommendation of DC/HoD. The reasons shall be such that scholar is not in a position to do the regular research activities. On recommendations of the Dean (Academics), the Chairman, Senate will approve such semester breaks, which shall be reported to the senate. The semester break shall be given initially for one semester. Applications along with appropriate documents like medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner endorsed from the Institute medical officer, must be submitted well in advance of the date of com-

mencement of the medical leave requested. Before joining back, a fitness certificate from the doctor who treated the student, with endorsement from the Institute Medical Officer has to be submitted. Semester breaks can not be taken continuously for two semesters except for the serious medical issue (proof for the same shall be submitted).

- b. The Scholars desirous of initiating a start-up venture, shall submit their business proposal to the FIC (Institute Innovation Cell) through HoD. The proposal shall be scrutinized by an Institute Level Review Committee of experts constituted by the Director. Based on the recommendation of the committee, the Director may approve the proposal for startup formation through the Institute. Once the startup is registered through the Institute, Scholar concerned can submit an application for semester break, if required, to Dean (Academic) through guide/HoD, for their start-up activities. The semester break shall be given initially for one semester and further extensions will be given based on a review of the progress and recommendation by the HoD and FIC(IIC) for a period of maximum one more semester by the Director.
- c. The period of semester breaks under (iv (a) and (b)) will not be counted in the prescribed time limit for completion of the programme. These semester breaks are normally allowed only after the completion of course work (R11). Financial assistance/scholarship if any from the Institute cannot be availed during this period. During such period of breaks, scholar shall pay prescribed fees in every semester and register to maintain their Ph.D. registration followed by DC meeting/recommendation. If a registration date falls during the period of breaks, scholar can complete the registration procedures at the expiry of the breaks

R9. Research Guide/Supervisor

Every research scholar admitted to the Ph.D. Programme undertakes research under the guidance of faculty member(s) of the Department in which the scholar is admitted. The faculty member is called Guide of the scholar. Guide(s) for a research scholar will be allotted by the concerned HoD, based on the area of research in line with the preferences of the research scholar and the prospective guides depending on mutual research interests, after obtaining the consent from the guide(s) and the research scholar. The guide is primarily responsible for the supervision of research work by the scholar and also academic well-being of

the scholar. A scholar may have a Co-Guide from the same or another Department based on the academic requirements, appointed by the Head of the Department. There shall be no more than two guides from the institute for a research scholar. Co-guide can also be professionals from industry/R&D organizations, approved by the senate (see R9 (iv)), if their expertise is essential for the research. Guide shall have the main responsibility of the academic and research activities of the scholar. Until the guide is allotted, Head of the Department will act as a mentor for the scholar. All regular faculty members of the institute (possessing Ph.D. degree) who are not likely to retire from the services of the Institute or leave the Institute within 3 years are only eligible to become guides for Ph.D. level research work in the Institute.

The following categories of persons can act as Co-guide but not as a guide:

1. A faculty on contract with less than 3 years of service left at the time of appointment as a co-guide.
2. A permanent faculty member of the institute is likely to retire from the services of the Institute or leave the Institute within 3 years can only serve as co-guide.
3. A Visiting Faculty/adjunct faculty of the Institute with Ph.D. degree can act as a co guide.
4. Professionals from industry/R&D organizations with Ph.D or with substantial research experience equivalent to Ph.D: If such expertise is essentially required for the research of the scholar, guide shall submit the details and research credentials of the proposed person to act as Co-guide to the Chairman Senate for approval, with recommendations of HoD/Dean (Academics). Guide shall clearly justify the need of such induction.
5. Inspire Faculty or faculty under Ramanujan Fellowship etc. of the Institute approved by the DST or other bodies of GOI, will be permitted to act as Co-guide, provided he/she will be available full time with the Institute. If a scholar is allotted research guide (s), the scholar has to complete the programme under the supervision of such guide(s). However, due to unavoidable situations with valid reasons as mentioned below in R 9.1, the Chairman, Senate may permit a scholar to change his/her guide(s). Mutual consent of the scholar and guide(s) and recommendations of the DC/Head of the Department and Dean (Academics) are normally required in such cases. All such cases shall be reported to the Senate.

R 9.1 Change of Guide (s) and Allotment of Caretaker Guide for Ph.D. scholars:

A. Guide/Co-guide on long leave but less than 12 months

Under unforeseen circumstances if the guide is on long leave for a period upto 12 months then the co- guide if any (if he/she is from the same department) or another faculty from the research area, nominated by the HoD, will do the required administrative work and support till the guide returns from the leave, while the scholar will continue his/her research with guide through email, online mode, etc. In the case of co-guide on leave upto 12 months, he/she will continue to act as co guide through email, online mode.

B. In case of the Guide/Co-guide on long leave of more than 12 months

1. If the guide of a research scholar proceeds on long leave for more than 12 months, the co- guide ,if any, will continue to be the guide and do necessary coordination (if he/she is from the same department) , till the guide returns from the leave. If no co-guide exists for the research scholar or if the co guide is from other department, another guide (who can act as co-guide when the guide returns) may be appointed by the HoD from the same department, with the permission from Dean (Academics), till the guide returns from the leave.
2. If the scholar in his/her advanced stage of research (going to submit his/her thesis within 1 year or the thesis has been submitted) and the guide proceeds on long leave, co guide if any from the department will coordinate the activities. If there is no co-guide exists for the research scholar or if the co guide is from other department, a caretaker guide will be appointed by the HoD from the same department, with the permission from Dean (Academics). However, the responsibility of thesis verification and submission shall be with the guide and shall be done in time, without delay.
3. If the co-guide of a Ph.D. scholar is on long leave for more than 12 months then his/her service as a co-guide will automatically withdraw and the scholar continues to do the research with the guide. However, another co-guide may be permitted by the Dean (Academic) based on the recommendation of the DC/HoD, if found essential for the research by the scholar.

C. Resignation/Termination/Death of a Guide

A new guide will be appointed by the HoD/Dean (Academics), if necessary, depending upon the circumstances as per the guidelines in ‘A’ or ‘B’ above.

In the case of co-guide, another co-guide may be permitted by the Dean (Academic) based on

the recommendation of the DC/HoD, if found essential for the research by the scholar.

D. Guide declining to supervise

In case a guide declines to supervise a Ph.D. scholar for valid and essential reasons given in writing, another faculty member, qualified to be guide and actively engaged in the same area of research, who consents to supervise the research scholar, may be appointed as the new guide by HoD/Dean (Academics). After that, Doctoral Committee (DC) may be reconstituted by replacing the earlier guide with the new guide, and retaining the other internal and external expert members as in R10.

E. Change of guide(s) by the research scholar

If a Ph.D. scholar wants to change one of the guide(s) or both, under valid and essential reasons given in writing, new guide(s) may be appointed by the Chairman Senate on the recommendation of DC/ Head of the Department and Dean (Academics). Mutual consent of the scholar and guide(s) may be taken by HoD before the recommendation. In case change of the area of research is required with new guide(s), the DC shall be constituted afresh. If the area is different, additional courses required (as suggested by DC) shall be registered and successfully credited by the scholar. It is not recommended to change the guide by the scholar at a later stage of research, say after 4 semesters (or 2 years).

F. No additional period for research will be granted beyond the maximum duration mentioned in R.5, in any of the above cases.

R10. Doctoral Committee

Each scholar will have a Doctoral Committee (DC) appointed by the Institute.

- i. The Doctoral Committee will consist of Head of the Department or his/her nominee, in case HoD happens to be the guide (a senior faculty nominated from the same department by HoD), as Chairperson, guide (s) and two faculty members of which one from the same department (other than Chairperson) and the other should be from another Department or an external expert who are working in the research areas related to the proposed work of the scholar. The DC is constituted by the Department in consultation with the guide(s) within two weeks from the date of appointment of the guide(s) and with the approval of the Dean (Academics).
- ii. If faculty expert is not available in the area of research in the Institute, professionals from industry/R&D organizations/reputed Institute with sufficient research credentials may be considered as one of the DC members. Guide shall submit the details and research

credentials of the proposed person to act as DC member to the Chairman Senate for approval, with recommendations of HoD/Dean (Academics). Guide/HoD shall clearly justify the need of such induction.

- iii. Dean (Academic)/Chairman Senate shall have the right to be present in any DC meeting.
- iv. In case, any faculty member acting as DC member declines due to valid reasons or goes on long leave/resigns/retires from the Institute, another faculty member within/outside the department as required, shall be appointed as DC members by the Dean (Academic), and based on the recommendation from the guide/HoD.
- v. The major role of the Committee is to monitor the progress of the work, both course work and research, of the scholar up to the point of the award of the Degree. The Doctoral Committee meets at least once every semester. At the first meeting of the first semester of the scholar's Programme, the Committee identifies the courses to be credited/audited by the scholar based on the requirement and capabilities of the scholar (see clause R11 for details of course work).
At every subsequent meeting, the scholar submits a brief report on the progress of work highlighting contributions and outcomes and presents the progress of his/her work. The semester-wise report of the Doctoral Committee on the scholar's progress and the scholar's report attested by the guide are mandatory at the time of the registration /renew the registration of the scholar in each semester.
- vi. In case of any dispute between the scholar and the guide, the DC may consider it and recommend suitable remedial action. The DC is also empowered to recommend to the Dean (Academics) any disciplinary action in case of misconduct or unethical practices of the scholar.

R11. Course Work

Every Ph.D. scholar shall complete the coursework requirements as prescribed below by the Institute regulations applicable to their category of admission. Courses shall be selected by the DC, based on the research requirements and academic background of the scholar.

- i. The research scholars with Two years Masters Degree should successfully complete courses (PG/Ph.D. level) for a minimum total of 12 credits as prescribed by the DC. The scholar is required to complete all course work within two semesters of his/her initial

registration. For the course work, and he/she shall obtain minimum 'C' grade in every individual course registered for the successful completion of the course prescribed.

If the scholar could not meet the credit requirements at the end of the second year, he/she will be permitted to repeat the same once or register for another courses, as suggested by the DC. If the scholar fails to complete, he/she will be terminated by cancelling the registration (R16).

A scholar may be granted exemption up to 6 credits from the minimum course credit requirements as indicated above, by the DC, provided the Masters degree is from an Institute of Eminence/ National Importance under GOI and the year of post-graduation being not earlier than 2 years from the year of admission to Ph.D. programme.

ii. **Integrated scheme: Admission to MS-Ph.D.**

The minimum credit requirement for earning MS-Ph.D. degree is 32.

A. Course work plan: **First semester:** 12 credits of regular PG/Ph.D. level courses as prescribed by the DC; Total=12 credits. Typically, the course work is expected to be completed within the first semester. Scholar shall obtain minimum 'C' grade in every individual course registered for the successful completion of the courses prescribed.

Second semester: Two short term projects of total = 20 credits; The projects and credit distribution /evaluation will be decided by the guide based on the research requirement and academic background of the scholar and shall be approved by the DC.

There shall be evaluations by the DC/panel appointed by HoD, at the end of 2nd semester. Scholar shall obtain minimum 'C' grade for every short term projects. If the scholar could not meet the credit requirements at the end of the second year, he/she will be permitted to repeat the same once again or register for another courses, as suggested by the DC.

If the scholar fails to complete successfully, he/she will be terminated by cancelling the registration (R16).

B. The scholar shall commence preliminary research work in the second year along with the short term projects. There will be a pre-comprehensive examination by a panel of examiners appointed by the HoD (consisting of the DC members) to review the research work done during at the end of 2nd year and assess the scholar's potential for continuing the Ph.D. programme. If the pre-comprehensive examination is not

passed and not satisfactory, the scholar shall have an option to exit the programme with an MS degree with relevant specialization offered in the respective department, provided he/she has completed the credit requirements (32 credits) successfully or repeat the pre-comprehensive examination once after 3 months, with the approval of the DC/Dean (Academics).

- C. After completing the second year, successfully crediting the course work requirement and passed the pre-comprehensive examination, the scholars will begin 5th semester by merging with 3rd semester of regular Ph.D. scholars and then continue the Ph.D. programme including comprehensive examination etc.

iii. Integrated scheme: Direct Ph.D. from B.Tech.-MS (IIIT Kottayam), without any break

- A. Course work in 11th and 12th semesters: 6 credits of regular PG/Ph.D. level courses as prescribed by the DC;

Total=6 credits.

The course work shall be preferably completed in the 11th semester itself. Scholar shall obtain minimum 'C' grade in every individual course registered for the successful completion of the course prescribed by the DC.

- B. The scholar shall commence preliminary research work in 6th year along with the courses. On successful completion of the course work, scholar shall merge with 3rd semester of regular Ph.D. scholars and then continue the Ph.D. programme including comprehensive examination etc.

iv. Integrated scheme: Direct Ph.D. from M.Tech. (working professionals) (IIIT Kottayam), without any break

- A. Course work: The minimum credit requirement is 6. The courses shall be PG/Ph.D. level as prescribed by the DC. Scholar shall obtain minimum 'C' grade in every individual course registered for the successful completion of the course prescribed.

The course work shall be preferably completed in the 4th year itself.

- B. The scholar shall commence preliminary research work along with the courses. On successful completion of the course work, scholar shall merge with 3rd semester of regular Ph.D. scholars and then continue the Ph.D. programme including comprehensive examination etc.

v. **Direct Ph.D. from e-M.Tech. (IIIT Kottayam), without any break**

- A. Course work: The minimum credit requirement is 6. The courses shall be PG/Ph.D. level as prescribed by the DC. Scholar shall obtain minimum 'C' grade in every individual course registered for the successful completion of the course prescribed. The course work shall be preferably completed in the 3rd year itself.
- B. The scholar shall commence preliminary research work along with the courses. On successful completion of the course work, scholar shall merge with 3rd semester of regular Ph.D. scholars and then continue the Ph.D. programme including comprehensive examination etc.

- vi. The DC has the liberty to recommend more additional courses to audit/register as relevant to the research to any of the scholars.
- vii. If a research scholar obtains a grade less than the specified minimum for any of the courses/projects registered, DC may permit to repeat the same course once again or to credit another relevant course as a replacement. If the research scholar still fails to obtain the specified minimum grade or above, DC can make appropriate recommendations including termination of the registration for the Ph.D. programme. All repetitions of failed courses/projects are chargeable as per the fees decided by the Institute administration.
- ix. All the courses to be credited by the research scholar shall be of Ph.D. level or Post-graduate (M.Tech. level semester-based courses only and with the approval of the DC. If Ph.D.-level or PG courses required by the scholar are not offered as part of the regular curriculum or through NPTEL/SWAYAM, the guide (s) shall propose the course (Ph.D. level) with the syllabus and evaluation scheme. The course shall be recommended by the Doctoral Committee (DC), reviewed by an academic experts outside the Institute (preferably from IIT) and approved by the Senate.
- x. Credits for meeting the above requirement can also be earned, if approved by DC, by successfully completing NPTEL/SWAYAM/similar online (approved by the Senate) courses. An approved NPTEL/SWAYAM/similar online PG course of minimum 12-week duration shall be considered as equivalent to a 3 credit course for the purpose of this requirement. All such courses shall be recommended by DC /approved by the Senate. Grading policy of such courses will be as per the guidelines prescribed by the senate.

- xi. Courses completed after the date of first registration of Ph.D. will only be counted towards the requirements for the award of Ph.D. Degree.
- xii. Grade calculation of courses is given annexure -1
- xiii Scholars under the following conditions are not eligible to write the end semester examination of any course registered:
 - If the attendance for the course is less than 80%
 - Any disciplinary action is pending against the scholar
 - Debarred from writing the examination by the institute

R12. Comprehensive Examination

To test the overall competence and academic preparation of a scholar in the Ph.D. Programme, a Comprehensive Examination is held within 18 months for scholars with master's degrees and within 30 months for the scholars only with Bachelor degrees from the date of admission/first registration. The above time limits are excluding the period of semester breaks or maternity leave sanctions and availed, if any. Comprehensive examination will have written or oral / viva or both components as decided by the DC and is held only after successful completion of course work requirements specified by DC. The scholar should not have any disciplinary actions against him/her and any dues or liabilities.

Once the scholar completes the course work requirements successfully and initial research works, he/she can inform the guide on his/her readiness for the comprehensive examination. Then the guide can convene the DC meeting for the recommendation of the comprehensive examinations along with the proposed examiners, date, mode of evaluation (written or oral/viva or both) and distribution of marks to Ph.D. Academics. The syllabus for the comprehensive examinations based on the course work completed (appropriate topics from each module of all the courses) and the core fundamental areas shall also be approved by the DC and shall also be communicated to Ph.D. Academics. The date of the Comprehensive Examination is informed to the scholar at least one month prior to the date of examination to ensure his/her readiness.

- i. The Comprehensive examination committee shall be Constituted by the HoD based on the recommendation from the DC with the approval from Dean (Academics), with the following composition:

Chairperson: DC Chairperson, Convener: Guide(s) and Members : minimum of 3 faculty members as subject experts from the relevant area of research, other than guide(s). As a best practice, there shall be at least one examiner from other Department. The Chairperson and the subject experts only shall award marks for the examination. Dean (Academic)/Chairman Senate shall have the right to be present in any Comprehensive Examination.

- ii. Candidate shall submit a brief report (4-5 pages) on her/his proposed research work (proposed research area with its significance, literature survey with research gaps, problem definition, objectives, methodology, novelty, research work carried out and expected outcomes of the research) and list of course work completed, one week prior to the guide which will be circulated to all the members of comprehensive examination.
- iii. Pattern/mode (written or oral/viva or both) and distribution of marks can be decided by DC.

The following is the Comprehensive examination strategies for oral/viva examination:

- (a) Presentation of the critique on the proposed research area.
 - (b) Presentation on proposed research problem and work carried out. Both (a) and (b) will form the first research seminar of the scholar and is open to all (see R14).
 - (c) Questions by the Comprehensive examination committee on the above presentations (a) and (b).
 - (d) Questions by the Comprehensive examination committee on the subject matter of the course work completed/credited by the scholar and on the fundamental concepts in the research area.
 - (e) Parts (a), (b) & (c) with the report submitted will have 60% weightage and (d) will have 40% weightage. A scholar is considered as “passed” only if the total score is 50% or above. Presentation by the scholar shall be limited to 30 minutes and maximum time shall be given for interactions and questions (about 60 minutes) by the committee.
- iv. A scholar failing in the Comprehensive Examination in the first attempt is given a second attempt not before one month and within six months from the date of the first attempt. Under any circumstances, comprehensive examination shall be completed within a period of two years from the date of first registration. If the scholar fails in the second attempt,

he/she is not allowed to continue in the Ph.D. programme and leads to cancellation of the registration of the scholar and removal from the rolls, with no obligation from the institute.

R13. Research Progress

1. Progress of the research by the scholar is assessed by DC through DC meetings or progress seminars conducted whenever required -minimum once in a semester.
2. Scholar shall submit a brief report on the progress of the research to all DC members (Problem definition, objectives, action taken on comments by earlier DC, work carried out in the semester with contributions/outcomes) prior to the DC meeting. The Doctoral Committee will make semester-wise assessment of the progress of the research work of the scholar and report to the Dean (Academics).
3. The DC may give necessary advice to the scholar in case of unsatisfactory performance in research.
4. DC shall ensure that research work is in proper direction and about 50% research work is completed with outcomes by the end of third year. This will enable the scholar to complete the work within five years.
5. In case of continued (consecutive 2 semesters) lack of progress/unsatisfactory progress or initiative on the part of the scholar, the DC may recommend the cancellation of fellowship /scholarship and issue a warning. If improvement is still not found by the next DC, DC can recommend appropriate actions including termination of the registration.
6. Ph.D. scholar receiving fellowship/scholarship, as per the rules of funding agency, on completion of two years as JRF and successful completion of comprehensive examination, the fellowship will be upgraded to SRF on the basis of assessment of research progress/achievements through a presentation before DC, Head of the Department and/or invited experts by HoD/Dean (Academics), if any. This evaluation for upgrading JRF to SRF shall not be clubbed with comprehensive examination.

R14. Research Seminars

The scholar has to give at least two open research seminars to the department:

- i. The first research seminar is a part of the comprehensive examination (see R12).
- ii. Subsequent to the first research seminar (as a part of comprehensive examination), the scholar has to give progress seminars of his/her research to the DC every six months till the Synopsis Seminar.
- iii. The second research seminar, called the synopsis seminar, will include the major observations, contributions and outcomes of the research work of the scholar (see R17 and R 18). The synopsis seminar will be given just prior to the submission of the Synopsis with the approval of the Doctoral Committee.

This seminar will be assessed by the Doctoral Committee and will be judged as satisfactory or unsatisfactory. In the latter case, a suitable course of action will be suggested by the DC including repetitions after sufficient/necessary additions/changes of research work.

R15. Change of Category- Full-Time to Part-Time Ph.D. and Vice-Versa

1. A scholar admitted to a full-time category may be allowed to change to part-time category on receipt of job offer from an organization for taking up the job/to join back the parent organization after their sponsorship period or on any unavoidable valid /essential reasons, with the fulfillment of the following conditions:
 - i. He/she has:
 - (a) completed the course work,
 - (b) passed the comprehensive examination,
 - (c) a paper publication based on the research work and
 - (d) completed sufficient quantity (more than 50%) of research work that is adjudged as satisfactory by DC based on the presentation given and detailed report submitted by the scholar.
 - ii. An open presentation on the research work completed by the scholar shall be given in the department, if DC suggests.
 - iii. Application from the scholar shall be enclosed with copy of the offer letter and no objection certificate from the Institution/Organization, which he/she proposes to

join (if so) along with a letter from the competent authority of the organization in which she/he is going to join/the employer, granting permission to continue the research.

- iv. Some of the above conditions under (i) may be waived/relaxed by the Chairman senate, only if the employment received by the candidate is the most appropriate to the qualifications of the candidate and full time under public sector, with no extensions possible in the joining time.
2. Apart from the above, DC may recommend the conversion from full-time to part-time on receipt of permanent full time employment, adequate and suitable to his/her qualifications and no extension of joining is permitted to complete all the conditions under (i) and (ii), based on the application from the scholar with proof, provided condition under (i (a)) is satisfied. If the employment is not full time or not adequate and suitable to his/her qualifications, no recommendations can be made.
3. Conversion from part time to full time will be allowed normally once during his/her programme and no further conversion is allowed.
4. Once the conversion is granted from full time to part time, scholarship/financial help if any availed by the scholar from the Institute will be stopped.
5. A scholar admitted to external registration category or under part time may be allowed to change his/her registration to full-time studies at the beginning of a semester on the recommendation of Doctoral Committee and approval from HoD/ Dean (Academics)/Director. This is may be generally without any financial assistance/scholarships from the Institute.

R16. Cancellation of Registration & Removal from the Rolls

1. The Ph.D. studentship is liable to be cancelled and the scholar is removed from the rolls of the institute at any time after the admission/ initial registration, for any or more of the following reasons:
 - i. Giving false information at the time of application/admission or any time during his/her programme.
 - ii. Not conforming to the regulations of the programme.

- iii. Failure in coursework requirement as per R11.
- iv. Failure in Comprehensive Examination as per R12.
- v. Consistent lack of progress observed by the DC, in research as per R13
- vi. Violation of discipline and conduct rules of the Institute as per R24.
- vii. Not submitting the thesis within the stipulated period permitted as per R18.
- viii. Not joining the Institute once selected for admission or enrolling for a semester within stipulated dates.
- ix. Scholar, remaining absent for more than 6 (six) weeks in a semester, without sanctioned leave/prior appropriate written intimation to the guide/HoD.
- x. The registration of a research scholar was not done for any one semester (a period of six months), is liable to be canceled (see R.6.6).

In all the cases, guide/HoD may inform the scholar concerned before initiating the steps for cancellation of registration. The decision of the Chairperson, Senate shall be final and binding in all the above cases. Fees paid by the scholar will not be refunded under in any of the above cases.

2. If the scholar wants to cancel his/her Ph.D. registration, he/she can submit an application with reasons to the HoD for recommendation of the guide/DC. If the scholar was enjoying any fellowship /scholarship from an external agency, the cancellation will also be as per the regulations of the agency. If the scholar was enjoying teaching assistantship, the amount paid under this by the Institute, shall be returned. If he/she has completed any course, corresponding grade cards will be issued and credits earned, if any, will be uploaded in ABC. No credit transfer certificate will be issued from the Institute. Under the above conditions, registration of scholar can be cancelled subject to submission certificates of no disciplinary action pending and no dues/liabilities to the institute.
3. Re-registration requests for such cases of cancellation of registration other than clauses R16.1.(i, ii, iii, iv, v and vi,) only, may be considered and recommended by the DC, if the reasons for the delay are found genuine and satisfactory. Permission for the re-admission based on the recommendations from DC may be granted by the Dean (academics)/Director. The candidates need to take admission again as per the admission process, as recommended by DC. On getting the admission, permission for the

re-registration may be granted on payment of full fee towards the period of absence and admission fee, as decided by the Institute. However, DC will reject the requests for re-admission/ re-registration, if the reasons for delay are not satisfactory. DC can also waive course work/comprehensive examination if already completed satisfactorily or it can suggest additional course work requirements/comprehensive examination to complete, if the research areas are different or updates of knowledge are required.

R17. Requirement for Submission of Thesis

The minimum requirement for submitting thesis is (i-a) two publications in well reputed SCI indexed or in Web of Science core collection and (i-b) two publications in Scopus indexed journals/conferences from the research work. OR (ii-a) one publication in a journal present in the list of Q1 journals of Web of Science core collection and (ii-b) One Scopus indexed journal (Q1) and three publications in Scopus indexed journals/conferences from the research work in the respective subject area based on the research work carried out.

A granted utility patent (Indian) from the research work, showing inventors name and with ownership to IIITK, is considered as equivalent to one SCI-journal publication. Apart from the above, the scholar must have successfully completed the course work requirements and passed the comprehensive examination, no disciplinary action pending and no dues/liabilities to the institute, to become eligible for the submission of the thesis.

R18. Thesis Synopsis

A research scholar shall be permitted by the DC to submit the synopsis of his/her thesis on completion of the research work both in quality and quantity and meeting the minimum requirement of thesis submission (R17).

A scholar shall submit the synopsis report of his/her thesis to the DC at least one week before the date of synopsis seminar, in the prescribed format. The synopsis contains outline of the research highlighting the observations, contributions and outcomes from the research.

The scholar makes a presentation of the thesis work before the DC in an open seminar (see R14 (ii)). If the DC approves the synopsis with incorporation of suggestions, if any in the open seminar, the scholar is allowed to submit the synopsis of the thesis. The guide sends the synopsis report in prescribed format to the Dean (Academics) through the Head of the Department for further processing, with necessary attachments.

If a scholar fails to submit the thesis within 3 months from the date of the Synopsis Seminar, the scholar shall present another Synopsis seminar, based on the recommendation of DC.

R19. Thesis Submission

Within three months of the acceptance of the synopsis by the DC, the scholar submits two copies of the thesis (both soft and hard copy), in the prescribed format to the academic section. The thesis is to be forwarded to the Dean (Academics) by the Guide(s) through the Head of the Department with due certifications along with necessary attachments including plagiarism reports. The scholar shall ensure a plagiarism level (similarity index) less than 15% for his/her research.

R20. Thesis Examination

The following steps are followed by the Dean (Academics) in processing the accepted synopsis.

1. The panel of examiners for thesis evaluation should be experts, working in the relevant field of research at the level of Associate Professor or Professor or at an equivalent level. Any relaxation if necessary on any specific reasons, may be permitted by the Chairman Senate on case to case basis after reviewing the merit, with the recommendations from DC/HoD/Dean (Academics).
2. After the approval of synopsis, the DC has to approve a list of five examiners working in the reputed higher learning institutes in India (IIT/NIT/IIIT/IISER/IIM etc) and five examiners working in the reputed institutes abroad (QS ranking <500), as per the category indicated under (1), in relevant field of research with contact details and their latest profile and the list should be communicated confidentially to academic section by the HoD.
3. A panel of two external examiners is confidentially selected by the Dean(Academics)/Chairman Senate - one from the list of Indian examiners and one from the list of foreign examiners suggested by the DC.
4. The synopsis is sent to the selected examiners by email and their willingness to examine the thesis is ascertained, by the academic section. If any examiner is unwilling to accept the examiner-ship, or no response is received within a fortnight, another examiner from the list will be selected as above and is contacted.

R21. Thesis Reports

The thesis submitted by the scholar with appropriate certifications from the guide and HoD, is sent to two external examiners for evaluation as per R20, for their comments on the originality and scientific merit of the findings of the author and to judge whether the work deserves the award of the Ph.D. Degree of IIIT Kottayam. Specifically they will be asked to give one of the following verdicts (Clauses):

1. “The thesis is acceptable as such without any revision. I recommend the award of the Ph.D. degree of IIIT Kottayam to the candidate.”
2. “The thesis is acceptable as such without any revision. I recommend the award of the Ph.D. degree to the candidate subject to his/her satisfying the Viva-Voce board about the questions/clarifications I have raised in my report.”
3. “The thesis needs revisions along the lines, I have suggested in my report. The Ph.D. degree can be awarded to the candidate after the revisions are made to the satisfaction of the Doctoral Committee and subject to his/her satisfying the Viva Voce board on the questions/clarifications. The revised thesis need not be sent to me.”
4. “The thesis needs revisions along the lines, I have suggested in my report. I wish to see the revised thesis.”
5. “The thesis is not acceptable for reasons I have detailed in my report. I do not recommend the award of the Ph.D. degree of IIIT Kottayam to the candidate.”

The following steps are taken by the Academic office after sending the thesis to the examiners:

- The examiners are reminded of the report every fortnight, after an initial period of 3 weeks.
- The examiners are expected to send reports on the thesis within two months from the date of receipt of the thesis.
- If no report is received within 3 months of sending the thesis after repeated reminders, a new examiner from the panel of examiners, may be appointed by the Dean (Academics), after giving appropriate intimation to the first examiner.
- If both the thesis examiners recommend the thesis for award of the Ph.D. degree (clause 1 and 2 above), the Dean (Academics) approves the conduct of a Viva-Voce examination. In the case of clause 3, Corrections in the thesis done by the

scholar, responses to the comments of the examiners, are ratified by the DC, and then the conduct of Viva-voce examination can be scheduled after approval from Dean(Academics).

- In the case of clause 4, the revised thesis, after appropriate modifications by the scholar and ratification by DC, should be sent to the examiner once again, for his/her verdict.
- If one external examiner recommends the thesis, and the other examiner not recommended (clause 5), then the thesis will be sent to a third examiner from the panel, for his/her review.
- If two external examiners do not recommend the thesis for the award (clause 5), Dean Academics may send the review comments to the Institute Research Committee (IRC) & DC to recommend further action. If the IRC and DC is satisfied with the work already done with minor corrections/additions, as suggested by expert committee/DC, the thesis may be sent to candidate to incorporate the suggestions/additions. After appropriate modifications of the thesis and ratified by the DC, thesis will be sent to another set of examiners from a fresh panel of examiners suggested by DC, by Dean/ (academics)/Chairman, Senate.
- If the IRC/DC is not satisfied with work as such and suggest major revisions, the scholar may be advised to augment the research substantially and submit the synopsis and thesis once again. This will be sent to the examiners selected from a fresh panel of examiners suggested by DC, for evaluation. If both the examiners do not recommend the thesis for the award for second time, the scholar is not awarded the degree and the registration will be cancelled.
- Viva-Voce examination can be held only when two final reports are with recommendations (clauses 1/2/3).

R22. Viva-Voce Examination

In a Viva-Voce examination, a scholar makes an oral presentation on his/her research work reported in the thesis. The presentation is open to all. The Viva Board is constituted by the Dean (Academics). Viva-Voce examination can be in the offline/hybrid mode with external examiner offline/online and all others including candidate offline attending in the campus. The composition of the Viva Board is as follows: The composition of the Board is as follows:

One External Examiner of the thesis within the country, or an expert in the subject nominated by the Dean (Academics) (only if the examiner who reviewed the thesis is unavailable), from the panel of examiners recommended by the DC	Member – External Examiner
Chairperson, DC or a senior faculty member from the Institute nominated by the Dean/Chairman, Senate	Chairperson
One faculty member of the department/institute with knowledge of the subject of the thesis and with research interest in the relevant area, nominated by the DC Chairperson	Member – Internal Examiner
Research Guide(s)	Member and Coordinator

The other members of DC of the scholar will be invitees to the oral examination. The Viva Board conducts the defense of the thesis by the candidate ensuring that the scholar answers all the queries of the thesis examiners, the viva board and audience satisfactorily. The Chairman reports the result of the Viva-voce examination in the specific format (available in academic office) to the Dean (Academics). If the Viva Board finds the performance of the scholar unsatisfactory, the scholar will be asked to reappear for another oral examination at a later date (not earlier than a month and not later than six months from the date of the first oral examination).

If the Viva Board finds the performance of the scholar unsatisfactory on the second occasion also, then the matter will be referred to the Senate for an appropriate decision.

R23. Award of Ph.D. Degree

If the Viva Board declares the candidate has performed satisfactorily during the Viva-Voce Examination and recommends that Ph.D. Degree be awarded to the candidate, the Dean (Academics) forwards the recommendation to the Senate of the Institute, provided the scholar has no dues/liabilities to the Institute and no disciplinary action pending against him/her. The Senate may then recommend the award of the Degree to the Board of Governors.

The scholar must submit final version of the thesis in the prescribed format after incorporating the suggestions of the examiners/ Viva Board, if any, along with necessary attachments to the academic office with the number copies as specified by the academic section. Scholar shall also submit a soft copy of the above final thesis to keep in the library.

R.24. Conduct and Discipline

All research scholars of the institute, irrespective of the category, shall strictly follow the code of conduct as given in Annexure 2. Any violation of these will lead to appropriate punishment including fine, cancellation of registration of Ph.D./ termination of the scholar.

R.25. Library and Hostel Regulations

Library and hostel regulations are listed in Annexure 3 and shall be strictly followed by all the research scholars of the institute, irrespective of the category.

R.26. Power to Modify

- i. In exceptional case, the Director, as the Senate Chairman may at his discretion override any of the above provisions.
- ii. Decision of the Director as the Senate Chairman shall be final and binding in all the cases in any of the rules.
- iii. Notwithstanding all that has been stated above, the Senate has the right to modify any of the above regulations from time to time.

R.27. Legal and Other Matters

Any legal matters relating to Rules and Regulation shall be subjected to jurisdictions of Court(s) in Kottayam.

R.28. Annexures

R.28.1 Annexure-1 Grading scheme for courses

- i. The Semester Grade Point Average (SGPA) is calculated as follows:

$$SGPA = \sum_i \frac{C_i GP_i}{\sum_i C_i}$$

where, C_i = credit for the course, GP_i = the grade point obtained for the course and $\sum_i C_i$ = the sum of credits in overall courses taken in that semester.

For the cumulative grade point average (CGPA), a similar formula is used where the sum $\sum_i C_i$ is the sum of credits of overall courses taken in all the semesters completed. Relative grading will be adopted for assigning grades in courses. The letter grades and the corresponding grade points are as follows:

Letter Grade	Grade Points	Remarks
A	10	Excellent
A ⁻	9	Very good
B	8	Good
B ⁻	7	Fair
C	6	Average
C ⁻	5	Poor
D	4	Pass
F	0	Fail
I		Incomplete (Subsequently to be changed into valid grade)
L		Insufficient attendance
W		Withdrawal due to special circumstances
U		Course Audit

- ii. **I Grade:** Scholars who are eligible to appear in the end semester examination but have missed the end-semester examination for valid reasons like any approved medical leave for hospitalization or any approved duty leave for participating in the assigned activities of the Institute/ in national events for the Institute in connection with the Ph.D., have been awarded I grade. They are eligible for a makeup examination which may be held a few days after the end semester examinations, if they meet 80% attendance and other academic requirements of the institute. Make-up examination for the mid-semester component (if absent due to the above valid reasons) shall be conducted based on the mutual convenience between the students and course faculty during the semester. The incomplete Grade I is a translational grade which will be given to scholars who miss the end semester examination under the above exceptional circumstances like serious medical reasons etc. Actual grade after the make-up examination will be taken and will reflect in the transcript replacing the I grade. No make-up examination will be scheduled for any other components of the evaluation scheme.

- iii. **U Grade:** This grade is awarded in a course that the scholar opts to register for audit. It is not mandatory for the scholar to go through the entire regular process of evaluation in an audit course. However, the scholar has to go through all the evaluation process and also the minimum attendance requirement, as stipulated by the Course Instructor and approved by the Head of the Department, for getting the “U” grade awarded in the course, failing which that course will not be listed in the Grade Card.
- A scholar can register for auditing a course, or a course can even be converted from Credit to Audit or from Audit to Credit, with the consent of the Guide/DC and Course Instructor until 2 weeks after the commencement of the classes in the semester as indicated in the Academic Calendar.

R.28.2 Annexure-2 Code of Conduct

2.1 Disciplinary policies of Indian Institute of Information Technology Kottayam (IIIT Kottayam) are put in place to ensure a secure academically enriching environment for all members of the community and to promote civility on campus. Students/Scholars of IIIT Kottayam are expected to show personal integrity, respect for Institute resources, and respect for others rights, for the values of scholarship and teaching. Students/Scholars are expected to adhere to the institute rules and regulations. Any violation will be handled according to the rules set forth by the Senate and Board of Governors of IIIT Kottayam. The administrators of the institute will notify parents/guardians if a Student/Scholar violates the Code of Conduct. Any of the following shall constitute violation of the Code of Conduct for Students/Scholars and makes the Students/Scholars liable to disciplinary action by the Institute.

- Lack of courtesy and disorderly conduct or disruptive acts (within or outside Institute premises).
- Any act that compromises the safety/security of individuals or Institutional facilities.
- Willful damage or unauthorized removal of Institute property.
- Unauthorized access to institutional facilities/records.
- Tampering of data/records (reading, copying or destroying).
- Any act of fraud/misrepresentation/dishonesty.

- Misappropriation of any belongings of fellow Students/Scholars /staff/faculty.
- Adoption of unfair means during examinations or misconduct in research.
- Infringement of personal privacy.
- Ragging in any form.
- Caste/religion/ethnicity/gender/physical disability based discriminatory behavior/remarks.
- Sexual harassment/assault.
- Possession of banned substances or dangerous items (illegal drugs, weapons, firearms etc.) that endangers safety of Students/Scholars himself/herself or others.
- Any act that affects the reputation/orderly conduct of the institute.

2.2 The Disciplinary Procedure

- The Discipline and Welfare Committee (DWC) of the Institute is constituted under the chairmanship of a faculty member by the Director. Depending on the issues of allegations involved, the Chairman of the DWC may invite additional members, for example the Coordinator of a Programme, Students/Scholars faculty adviser/research guide, Deputy Registrar (Academics & Administration) in case of academic related issues, to facilitate with the investigation.
- DWC will investigate the allegations of misdemeanors or violation of the Code of Conduct, without bias. The DWC will subsequently submit a fact-finding report and recommend disciplinary action(s), if any, to the Deans (Academic Affairs/ Student Affairs). Complaints related to caste/religion/ethnicity/gender-specific discrimination and sexual harassment will be investigated by an appropriate committee of the Institute and will report directly to the Director.
- While hearing the disposition of the accused Students/Scholars and witnesses, the Chairman, DWC may invite two senior Students/Scholars observers (with one woman and/or SC-ST observer if the accused Students/Scholars belong to the same community), to be present with the DWC.
- The Students/Scholar's observers are to be invited by the Chairman, DWC in consultation with the Dean (Student Affairs), from a list of nominees forwarded by the Schools. The list of nominees is valid for a year.

- The Students/Scholar's observer shall withdraw at the conclusion of the above and may submit their remarks (if any) in writing to the Chairman, DWC for consideration.
- The Chairman, DWC, shall keep records of the entire proceedings of the meetings.
- All disciplinary actions shall be notified in writing to the concerned Students/Scholars and their parents/guardians by the Office of the Registrar.
- A Student/Scholar who feels aggrieved with the disciplinary action may appeal to the Director. The appeal has to be filed within a period of one month from the date of intimation of disciplinary action stating clearly the case and explaining his/her position and reason(s) for reconsideration of the decision.

2.3 Disciplinary Actions

- Violation of the Code of Conduct shall invite disciplinary action, which may include penalties such as, reprimand, fine, suspension/expulsion from the hostel, debarring from examinations, withdrawing/withholding of scholarship/fellowship/benefits or access to institute facilities, withholding of grades and/or degrees, revoking of awarded degrees, suspension for a certain period or even permanent expulsion from the Institute.
- The Senate may withhold recommendation of a Student/Scholar, who is found guilty of a major offense, to the Board of Governors for the award of a degree, even if the Student/Scholar has satisfactorily completed all the academic requirements.
- Lack of knowledge of the rules and regulations is not admissible as an excuse or defense for misconduct/dishonesty, and shall not be a basis for leniency.

2.4 Disciplinary Action for Malpractices in Research

- Students/Scholars involved in conducting research at IIIT Kottayam are expected to maintain highest standards of integrity. Any form of unscrupulous conduct will be investigated by competent authorities and could warrant a variety of disciplinary actions, in severe cases cancellation of Ph.D. registration or even cancellation of an awarded Degree at any time.
- Research misconduct can take place in many forms, including deliberate interference with the integrity of the work of others, plagiarism, falsification of data, and fabrication of data. In particular, Students/Scholars are expected to observe the

practice of acknowledging source(s) of information reproduced in his/her thesis, reports, publications, or seminars.

- Plagiarism includes, without citation, the appropriation of another individual(s) text, results, or ideas.
- Falsification includes actions such as not accurately representing research records or results, manipulating reagents or equipment settings, to produce a preconceived outcome.
- Fabrication includes making up data and recording them.

2.5 Code of conduct in Examination Hall to be followed by the Scholars All scholars shall read and understand the code of conduct and strictly adhere to them. Unawareness of these rules will not stop from any punishment against malpractices. All scholars are hereby informed that Institute follows zero tolerance policy against examination malpractice and any malpractice attempt from the student(s) will lead to severe punishments that include, but not limited to:

- Awarding F grade for the selected subjects in the examination with or without giving chance of repeat examination
- Awarding F grade for the selected subjects in the examination and shall be awarded one grade less for all the other theory courses registered in the semester
- Awarding F grade for all theory subjects in the examination in that semester with or without giving chance of repeat examination
- De-registration of all the courses enrolled in the current semester
- Debarring from examinations for a specific duration like 2 or more semesters
- Debarring from campus placement activities
- Termination from the Institute

Any combination of the above punishments may also be applied depending on the gravity of the offense. The following instructions are to be meticulously followed by all the scholars in the exam hall:

- (a) The scholars must occupy their seats in the examination hall at least 15 minutes before the examination starts. Entry to the examination hall will not be permitted 15 minutes after the start of examination.

- (b) The seating arrangements made by the institute must be strictly followed by scholars as they are not allowed to make any changes. The scholars should be seated in accordance with their assigned roll numbers that are displayed in the hall.
- (c) As per the institute policy, you must wear the ID Cards when you are in the campus and hence in the exam halls. If by chance a student loses the institute Id card, they must apply for a new one. Until they receive the new ID card, they are required to obtain a duplicate I-card from the IT Support Team (BB217) by paying the prescribed fee. No extra time will be granted if you misplace your ID card and lose time collecting a duplicate (as per the above mentioned procedure) during the examination. (Digital copies of the ID card on mobile or gadgets are not valid).
- (d) Scholars are not permitted to bring any bag, pouch or loose or written or blank sheets other than those permitted by the course faculty to the examination hall. Any code books/data handbooks/other hand-outs carried by the scholars shall be duly attested/endorsed by the course faculty. Any additional scribing in such materials with pen or pencil will be treated as exam malpractice and punishable. Possession or use of chits (including blank paper), notes, books, sheets or any information related to their course/study, in any form including writing answers/tips/formulae/equations/algorithms/figures/sketches/block diagram/data etc. on the student's body or clothing or other wear, walls, furniture or keeping or leaving such material at the examination venue or other surrounding areas (like toilets, windows, veranda etc.), are considered as malpractice and attract punishment, even if they are not using the above during the exam. It will be the responsibility of the concerned scholars to keep their things/belongings which are not permitted inside the exam hall, including mobile phones/other electronic gadgets/laptops/tabs etc., safe outside the examination hall. The Institute/Invigilators will not be responsible for any loss/damage in this regard. Mobile phones/laptops/tabs/ Smart watches/Bluetooth devices/similar electronic gadgets or other transmitting or receiving devices, or other means of communication or any other electronic device or any AI-based tools are strictly banned in examination halls. Carrying such devices to the exam hall or nearby areas or leaving such devices in the exam hall or nearby areas and/or Possession of non-permissible or unwanted materials (materials not required in the exam hall) will be treated as a serious case of exam malpractice, even if they are not using the above during the exam.

Scientific calculators (non- programmable without internet enabled) are only al-

lowed only if permitted by the faculty instructor. No exchange of calculators allowed. Attempting to access the internet in any manner is strictly prohibited and will be considered as exam malpractice, if noticed. Use of mobile phone as calculator or clock are not allowed inside the examination hall.

- (e) Bio-break shall be availed once only if very essential and necessary. The time of exit and entry for bio-break during examination shall be recorded in the form available with the invigilator. Any misuse of bio-break will be treated as an attempt for examination malpractice and punishable. Scholars are strongly suggested to attend the nature call before sitting for the examination to avoid going to washrooms/toilet during the examination.
- (f) Immediately after the Main Answer Booklets are issued to the scholars, they should fill in the relevant fields on the front sheet. ID card shall be made available to the Invigilator for verifying the filled data.
- (g) Scholars shall ensure that the invigilator signs the main answer book after the verification. Also all additional sheets are to be signed by the invigilator. Any answer books submitted without the signatures of the invigilator will be treated as invalid.
- (h) Scholars should mark their attendance in the relevant form provided by the invigilator.
- (i) Immediately after the question papers are issued to the scholars, the scholars should write their name and Roll No. on the question paper. It is also instructed that no other pen/ pencil markings are to be made by the student in the question paper. Any such actions will be treated as an attempt for malpractice.
- (j) Scholars have to ensure that the Sl.No. of the answer Booklet and the Roll No.of the student are duly entered on each of the Additional Sheets, by the student, as soon as the same is issued to the student.
- (k) Any attempt by a student to discuss with fellow scholars or copy from fellow scholars will be treated as exam malpractice and action will be taken against all the scholars involved.
- (l) Any attempt by a student to help another fellow student for copying will also be treated as exam malpractice and action will be taken against both the scholars. During the examination, possession of unauthorized materials, exchange of

materials/answer sheets/question papers, improper use of materials, misconduct, cheating, adoption of unfair means and unauthorized removal of material from examination halls or ignoring instructions given by invigilators, will automatically lead to disciplinary action against the scholars involved.

- (m) Threatening/requesting the neighbour or any other to show the answer script or to tell the answer/give a hint will be treated as exam malpractice
- (n) Misbehaviour or disobedience in the examination hall (unruly conduct, misbehaviour with invigilator, TA ,any staff or any student) will also be treated as exam malpractice
- (o) Scholars are not allowed to enter the examination hall after half an hour from the start of the examination. Scholars are not to be allowed to exit the examination hall within the first 45 minutes from the start of the examination.
- (p) Last 5 or 10 minutes during examination shall be used for proper tying the answer sheets and then verification. When the invigilator instructed to stop writing at the closure of examination, all scholars shall stop writing and hand over the answer sheet to the invigilator. Unused additional sheets should be duly returned to the invigilators.
- (q) Impersonation in the examination (for both the scholars) will also be treated as exam malpractice and will be a very serious offense.
- (r) During or after the distribution of answer sheets by the course faculty, scholars shall not attempt to correct the wrong answers, manipulate the marks awarded and scribe additional answers in the answer books. Any such acts of academic dishonesty will also be treated as examination malpractice.
- (s) Any other case not mentioned above and reported as malpractice by invigilators or any official invigilation squad visiting the exam hall.
- (t) If any malpractice is found during examination, the invigilator will ask the student (s) to stop writing the answer sheets. He/she will collect all the exhibits/evidence. . The nature of malpractice observed will be written in the answer sheet and signed by the invigilator with date & time. Student may be allowed to continue to write the examination by the officials of the Institute, which does not mean no action/punishments on malpractice.
- (u) Punishment will be as recommended by the Department level committee for mal-

practice or Institute level committee for malpractice and will be decided and implemented by the Institute. Decision of the Chairman, Senate will be final and binding in all the aspects.

2.6 Honour Pledge

The student must sign and submit to the Institute the following Honour Pledge at the time of registration in the semester. The pledge must be counter-signed by the parent/guardian.

IIIT Kottayam Student Honour Pledge

- I promise, on my honour, that I will conduct myself in the Institute and outside, with decorum and decency befitting the high moral and ethical standards expected of the members of the National Institute, IIIT KOTTAYAM and follow its Code of Conduct, Rules and Regulations.
- I will not engage in ragging. I understand that ragging is unlawful and liable to prosecution by law enforcement authorities of the State besides any disciplinary action the Institute may take which may include dismissal from the Institute.
- I will not engage in overt/covert sexual harassment.
- I will not resort to any dishonest practice in examinations/assignments.
- I will not engage in plagiarism in my writings and will acknowledge the work of other authors according to international practices.
- I will follow the Library and Hostel regulations of the Institute.
- I understand that violation of this pledge makes me liable to disciplinary action by the Institute.

Sd/-
Student

Sd/-
Parent/Guardian

2.7 Anti-ragging

The student and his/her parent/guardian should also sign, at the time of admission, the prescribed anti-ragging forms (visit <https://www.iiitkottayam.ac.in/#!/antiragging>) as per the stipulation of the MoE, Govt. of India.

R.28.3 Annexure-3: Library & Hostel Regulations

3.1 Library Regulations

1. Library Hours:
 - (a) Monday to Friday: 9 AM to 7.30 PM
Saturday: 9 AM to 5 PM
Sunday and Holidays: Closed
 - (b) During Exam Week: 9 AM to 10 PM.
 - (c) Circulation Timing: Monday to Friday: 9.15 AM to 5.15 PM
Saturday: 9 AM to 12 Noon
2. Membership: All registered scholars are eligible for membership in the institute library.
3. Scholars can borrow maximum 4 books at a time for 2 weeks, provided they do not have any overdue book. (Note: Some books may have a shorter loan period depending on the demand)
4. Users must leave their bags and other belongings outside the Library. Only notebooks and papers are allowed inside the library. Borrowed books are allowed to be taken to the library for return/renewal only. All items taken out of the library (including personal items, if any) are to be produced for verification by the check point staff engaged in front of the library.
5. Scholars must carry their identity cards inside the library and it must be produced whenever asked for. Identity card is mandatory for borrowing books from the Library.
6. Strict silence has to be maintained by all users in the library.
7. Use of mobile phones, consumption of food and drinks are strictly prohibited inside the library.
8. Use of the user PC kept inside the library is allowed only for accessing library catalogue, e-journals, e-books and academic databases.
9. Return of book is mandatory before the due date. A fine per day per book for the first week. Renewal of a book is possible only if there is no pending reservation against it. A book may be recalled any time before the due date, if it is urgently required by another member. A late fee per day per book will be imposed for the

noncompliance with the requirement. Rate of fine shall be decided by the Institute administration.

10. Any book, including reference books can be borrowed for overnight reference, at the closing time of the library and to be returned at 9 AM on the next working day. Only one book can be borrowed for overnight reference. A late fee per day per book for the delayed return of such book will be charged, as decided by the Institute administration.
11. Mutilation of books in any form (e.g. underlining, writing on pages, tearing off pages, damaging the binding etc.) will lead to a heavy fine or even replacement of the book. Before borrowing a book users should ensure the condition of the book and bring to the notice of the library staff, if any mutilation is found.
12. Members who lose/mutilate library books are liable to replace it with its latest edition along with a penalty of 20% of the total cost of the book. All such replaced books must be of the latest edition. If the book is part of a set or series they may be called upon to replace the whole set or series. In case of the lost books is untraceable in market or out of print Library Committee reserves the right to decide appropriate penalty.
13. Scholars must return all the books they borrowed before they go for vacation.
14. Users should obey the Library Rules and Regulations. Violation of rules and any act of misbehavior will be brought to the notice of the Library Committee Chair, and will lead to strong disciplinary action.

3.2 Rules and Regulations of Hostel Residence

1. Movement and Presence on Campus:
 - (a) Scholars are expected to remain within the Institute premises or in the hostel throughout the duration of the semester.
 - (b) Leaving the Institute campus during academic hours is strictly prohibited, unless prior permission has been granted by the concerned authority.
2. Night Return and Departure Timings:

All scholars are strictly prohibited from roaming the campus after 9:30 PM. After this time, scholars must either return to their respective hostels or remain inside their designated classrooms for study purposes only, up until 10:30 PM. All scholars

must return to their respective hostels by 11:00 PM. Scholars CAN NOT leave the hostels after 11:00 PM. Parents of defaulters shall be contacted, and the local police may be informed in case such activities occur without prior permission of the Warden.

3. Leave and Absence from Campus:

(a) Scholars must obtain permission through the Outpass portal

(<https://outpass.iitkottayam.ac.in/>) or the Biometric Outpass system (<https://gatepassstud>) before leaving campus during weekends or non- academic hours, provided the duration of absence does not exceed one day.

(b) For any absence involving an overnight stay outside the campus, scholars are required to submit a leave form (obtainable from the Academic Office/Hostel Office), approved by their guide and the concerned hostel Warden/Assistant Wardens.

(c) Scholars going for an internship must submit the leave form duly approved by their guide and the Warden.

4. Permanent Address and Contact Details:

Permanent address, including phone numbers (both Land/mobile) of parent(s)/guardian(s), must be given to the Warden/IIIT Office. The address must be updated whenever there is a change due to shifting or change of phone number, etc.

5. Interchange of Rooms/Hostels:

Scholars are not allowed to interchange rooms/hostels without obtaining the approval of the Warden/Chief Warden/Associate Dean (Hostel Affairs).

6. Responsibility for Damage to Property:

The resident(s) of a room are responsible for any damage to the property in the room during their occupancy and are liable to pay for the damage.

7. Vacation Stay:

All scholars must vacate the hostel during vacation time. If any student wishes to stay back during the vacation, special permission must be obtained from the competent authority in advance. An additional mess fee and hostel fee will be levied based on the duration of the extended stay.

8. Noise Prohibition:

Any kind of loud noise in the rooms, corridors, or premises of the hostel, especially during the night, is prohibited.

9. Cleanliness and Personal Belongings:

Scholars are required to take care of their personal belongings, keep their respective rooms clean, and maintain tidy hostel premises. Waste shall not be thrown outside. Plastic bottles/waste must be dropped in designated waste bins.

10. Care of Hostel Property:

Scholars are required to take utmost care of the hostel furniture, TV, washing machines, building structure, electrical fittings, etc.

11. Unidentified Damage:

In case of damage to any part of the hostel buildings, furniture, apparatus, or other property of the Institute caused by inmates of the hostel, the loss shall be recovered from the persons identified as responsible. However, if the persons causing damage cannot be identified, the cost of repairing the same may be assessed and levied equally amongst all inmates of the hostel or the group found responsible.

12. Defacement and Vandalism:

- (a) Scholars shall not paste posters or pictures, scribble on walls, or vandalize doors, windows, shelves, or any other hostel property. A fine proportionate to the damage caused will be levied by the Warden or other competent authority.
- (b) If any such damage or defacement is found during the first entry into the allotted room, the student must immediately report it in writing to the respective Assistant Warden or Warden.
- (c) Failure to do so may result in the student being held responsible for the damage.

13. Prohibition of Intoxicants and Banned Substances:

- (a) The use, possession, or consumption of drugs, alcoholic beverages, tobacco products, or any intoxicating substances is strictly prohibited within the hostel premises. Smoking is also not permitted under any circumstances.
- (b) Bringing or storing items that are banned under State or Central Government laws—including but not limited to explosives, narcotics, and other controlled substances—into the Hostel or Institute premises is a serious offense.
- (c) The guidelines and directives issued by the Institute Anti-Narcotics Cell/Club and/or the local administration shall be binding on all scholars.
- (d) Violation of these regulations will attract severe disciplinary action, which may include expulsion from the hostel, rustication from the Institute, or other penalties as deemed appropriate by the authorities.

14. Conduct with Others:

Scholars should strictly avoid arguments with fellow inmates, locals, security officers, or matrons of the hostel.

15. Cooking and Electrical Appliances:

Cooking inside the rooms is strictly prohibited. Scholars are not permitted to use heaters, electric irons, or similar appliances of any kind consuming electricity in the rooms. Close water taps after use.

16. Guests:

Guests are strictly prohibited from entering hostel rooms. Visiting hours are permitted only until 7:00 PM, and all guest meetings shall be restricted to the designated area at the main entrance, adjacent to the security guard post. No guest shall be permitted beyond this point under any circumstances.

17. Emergency Contact:

In case of any emergency (illness, accidents, etc.), contact the concerned Warden.

18. Electrical Safety and Fines:

Please switch off all electrical equipment after use. If found otherwise, a fine will be levied, including recovery of the cost of electrical equipment/fittings/appliances, etc.

19. Loss of Personal Belongings:

Please take care of your personal belongings. Institute/hostel authorities/wardens are not responsible for any loss, damage, or theft of any such items kept by inmates.

20. Furniture Movement:

The resident shall not move any furniture/appliance from its proper allotted place.

21. Outdoor Games and Celebrations:

(a) Scholars are strictly prohibited from playing outdoor games such as cricket, football, volleyball, badminton, etc., in the corridors, balconies, wings, or any other common areas within the hostel premises, as these activities may cause damage to property or disturb fellow residents.

(b) Birthday celebrations are permitted only in the designated open area adjacent to the hostel and must be conducted in the presence of the hostel security in-charge. If Institute property such as chairs or tables is used for the celebration, it must be returned promptly in good condition after the event.

- (c) All such celebrations must conclude by 12.00 -12:30 AM, beyond which no further activity will be permitted.
 - (d) Beating or any type of physical assault as part of birthday celebrations is strictly prohibited.
22. Maintenance Works:
- Scholars should cooperate while maintenance works are carried out and vacate their rooms completely when the maintenance section requires the rooms for this purpose. On such occasions, scholars shall be provided alternate accommodation.
23. Vacating Procedure:
- (a) Scholars going on vacation or leave are required to remove their belongings from the room and place them in the common storeroom assigned for this purpose with proper marking. They must hand over the room key to the security personnel or caretaker staff after making the necessary entry in the register.
 - (b) Scholars must also clear all dues and obtain a No-Dues Certificate in order to vacate the hostel during vacation.
24. Loss of Keys/Lock:
- Cost of the lock must be paid for losing room keys or lock.
25. Safety and Security:
- For safety and security, scholars are strictly advised not to climb rocks/mountains or go into forest areas, bushes, or nearby private properties.
26. Anti-Ragging Regulations:
- The Institute's anti-ragging regulations must be strictly followed in the hostels as well.
27. In/Out Register:
- Scholars must record their entry and exit in the In/Out Register maintained at the caretaker desk of their respective hostel. Any instance of forgery or signing on behalf of others will be treated as a strict violation. All scholars must sign/give biometric attendance between 9:00 PM to 11:00 PM in the hostel In/Out register.
28. Knowledge of Rules:
- Every student must familiarize themselves with all hostel rules and regulations and adhere to them strictly. Ignorance of the rules will not be accepted as an excuse.

29. Grievance Redressal:

It is the responsibility of hostel inmates to keep their rooms tidy. Any sort of grievance or complaint shall be recorded in the complaint register available at the desk of the security in-charge. If appropriate remedial action is not taken within three working days, the student may escalate the complaint to their corresponding Assistant Warden or Warden.

30. Hostel Timings

- Outpass/Gate in: 9:00 PM
- Move to hostel from academic/hostel premises: 9:30 PM
- Move to hostel from classrooms: 10:30 PM
- Hostel main door closes: 11:00 PM

31. Vehicle Timing for Off-Campus Scholars:

Off-campus scholars must travel to and from the Institute strictly according to the trip schedule. Any violation may lead to overcrowding in subsequent trips and will not be permitted.

32. Online Food Deliveries:

All online food deliveries must be recorded in the register at the hostel security desk.

33. Indoor Games:

Indoor games are strictly prohibited after 9:30 PM.

34. Visiting Other Hostels:

Scholars are strictly prohibited from visiting other hostels.

35. Silence Hours:

Silence hours will be observed from 11 PM to 6.00 AM on all days. No noise of any sort will be permitted. Residents shall not go to others rooms and disturb the inmates. Complaints from other residents will be investigated, and action will be taken accordingly.

36. Pets and Stray Animals:

Pets of all kinds are prohibited inside the hostel/quarters. Feeding stray dogs or cats in the hostel/institute premises is not permitted.

VIOLATION OF ANY OF THE ABOVE RULES SHALL MAKE THE STUDENT LIABLE TO APPROPRIATE DISCIPLINARY ACTION BY THE INSTITUTE.